



Admin Quick Start Guide

What you need to know to get started

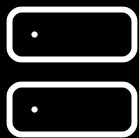
How do I get started?

This is what the setup looks like

Step 1. Gather **Your Credentials**



Websites



Servers



Cloud
Services



API keys



Databases



Other
credentials

- ✓ Gather your credentials
- ✓ Remove outdated, duplicate, or inactive credentials
- ✓ Remove what your team no longer uses

Step 2. Design Your **Folder Architecture**. Foundation of a successful rollout

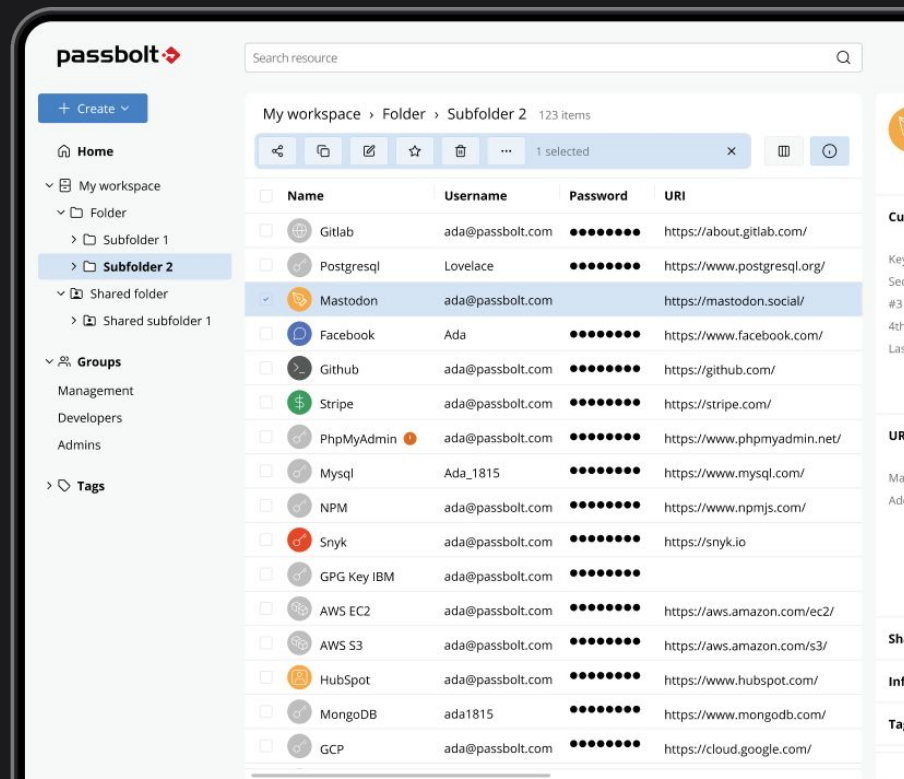
Mirror Your Organisation

Choose your folder structure to group passwords

- ✓ Department-Based / Project-Based / Client-Based / Business Unit-Based, etc.
- ✓ Nest folders to improve navigation. Avoid one massive catch-all folder.

Create groups (of users) that mirror your departments

- ✓ Group users based on shared access needs to simplify permissions.
- ✓ Strongly advise to import Active Directory groups (Pro feature).



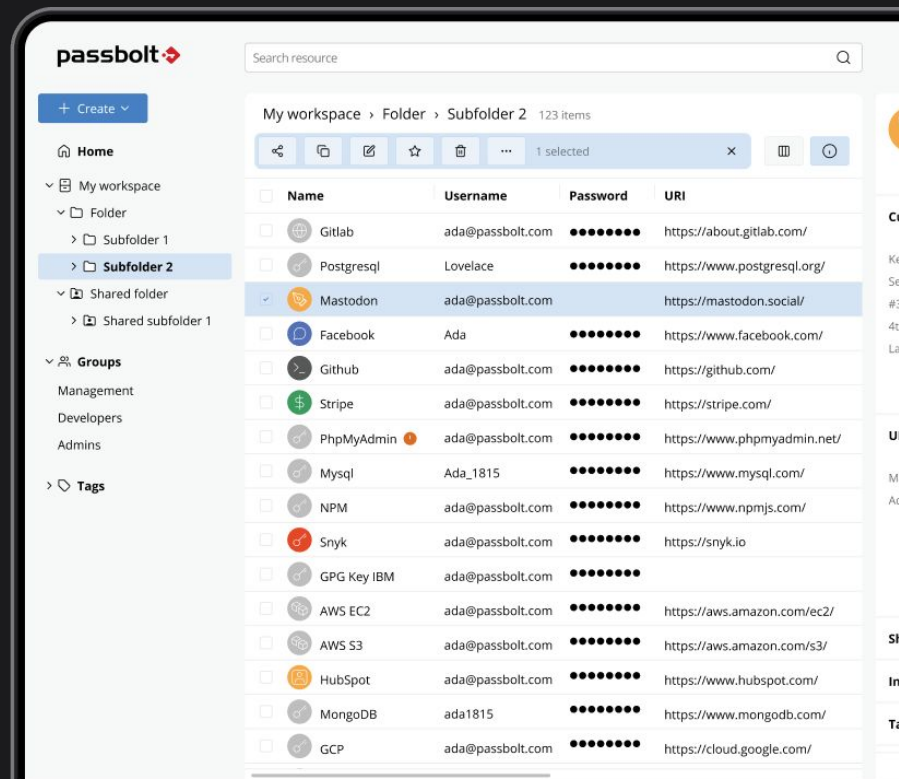
Step 2. Design Your **Folder Architecture**. Foundation of a successful rollout

Principle of Least Privilege

When your folder structure and groups are set up correctly, least privilege happens naturally. Each user sees only what they need.

The principles to follow:

- ✓ Assign permissions at group level; sharing with an individual should only ever be an exception.
- ✓ Share one folder with several groups when more than one team genuinely needs it, rather than duplicating folders.
- ✓ Give each group only the permission it requires, such as Read-Only or Update (refer to step 7).
- ✓ As an admin, keep owner permissions on main folders to maintain visibility of corporate resources.

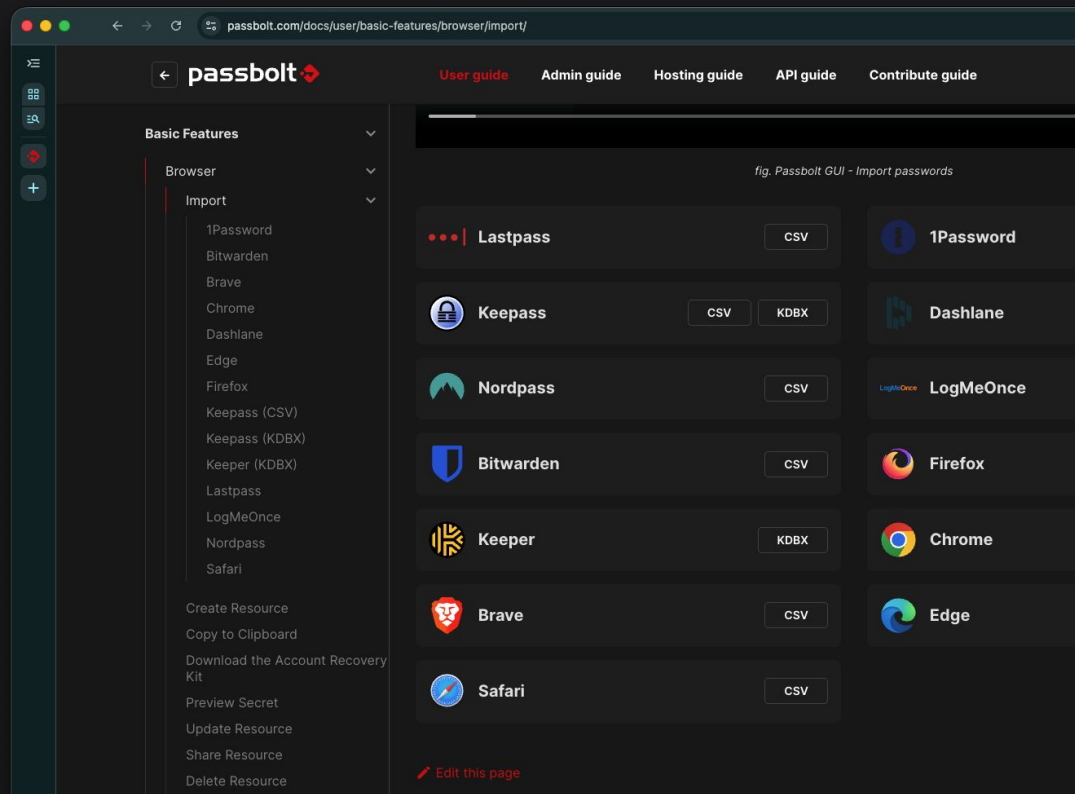


Step 3. Import **Your Credentials**

Import passwords in passbolt

Import the CSVs or the KeePass file within the relevant folder structure defined in step 2.

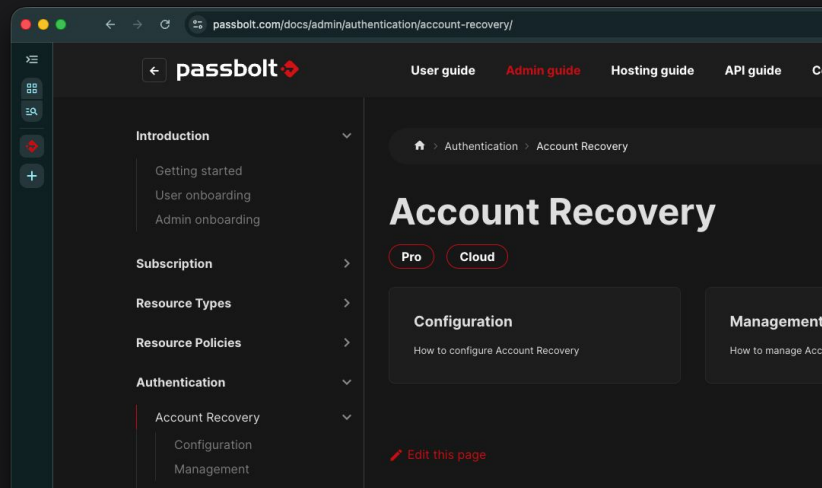
**TIP: IT Department owns
the initial import**
gather the initial credential setup



Step 4. Setting Up the **Organisation Recovery Key** before importing users!

Ensure users can regain access if they lose their **private key** or **passphrase**

1. Configure your Organisation Recovery Key: Select Prompt (recommended). New users are automatically enrolled during setup.
2. Recover an user account: If a user loses access click "Help, I lost my passphrase" on the login screen to start the recovery process.



TIP: Good timing to also configure your Security Baseline

- ✓ Resources policies, expiry, and secret history.
- ✓ Authentication policies, Single Sign-on (SSO), Passphrase policies, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- ✓ Offline mode to mark individual resources as available offline.
- ✓ Notifications and more information about role-based access control in the next slide.

Step 5. Setting Up Role Based Access Control (RBAC)

Restrict specific actions for regular users or create custom roles to grant elevated permissions to selected users only.

1. Remove the possibility for your users to export credentials.
2. Give your support team the possibility of performing account recoveries.
3. Hide the user workspace.
4. Disable the possibility to configure phone or desktop app, etc.

The screenshot displays the 'Organisation settings' interface. On the left is a sidebar menu with options: Home, Subscription, Resource types (Metadata key, Encrypted metadata, Migrate metadata, Allow content types), Resource policies (Password Expiry, Password Policy, Secret history), Authentication (User Passphrase Policies, Account Recovery, Single Sign-On, MFA Policy, Multi Factor Authentication), User provisioning (SCIM, Users Directory, Self Registration), Emails (Emails, Email server, Email Notifications), Role-Based Access Control (highlighted), and Internationalisation.

The main content area is titled 'Organisation settings' and 'Home > Role-Based Access Control'. It features a 'Role-Based Access Control' section with a description: 'In this section you can define access controls for each user role.' and an 'Add role' button.

Below this is a table for configuring permissions for three roles: Admin, User, and Group Admin. The table is divided into 'API Permissions' and 'UI Permissions'.

	Admin	User	Group Admin
API Permissions			
Group management			
Create a group	Allow	Deny	Allow
Account recovery request			
Account recovery request view	Allow	Deny	Deny
Account recovery request index	Allow	Deny	Deny
Account recovery request review	Allow	Deny	Deny
UI Permissions			
Resources			
Import/Export			
Can import	Allow	Allow	Allow
Can export	Allow	Allow	Allow
Password			
Can preview	Allow	Allow	Allow
Can reset	Allow	Allow	Allow

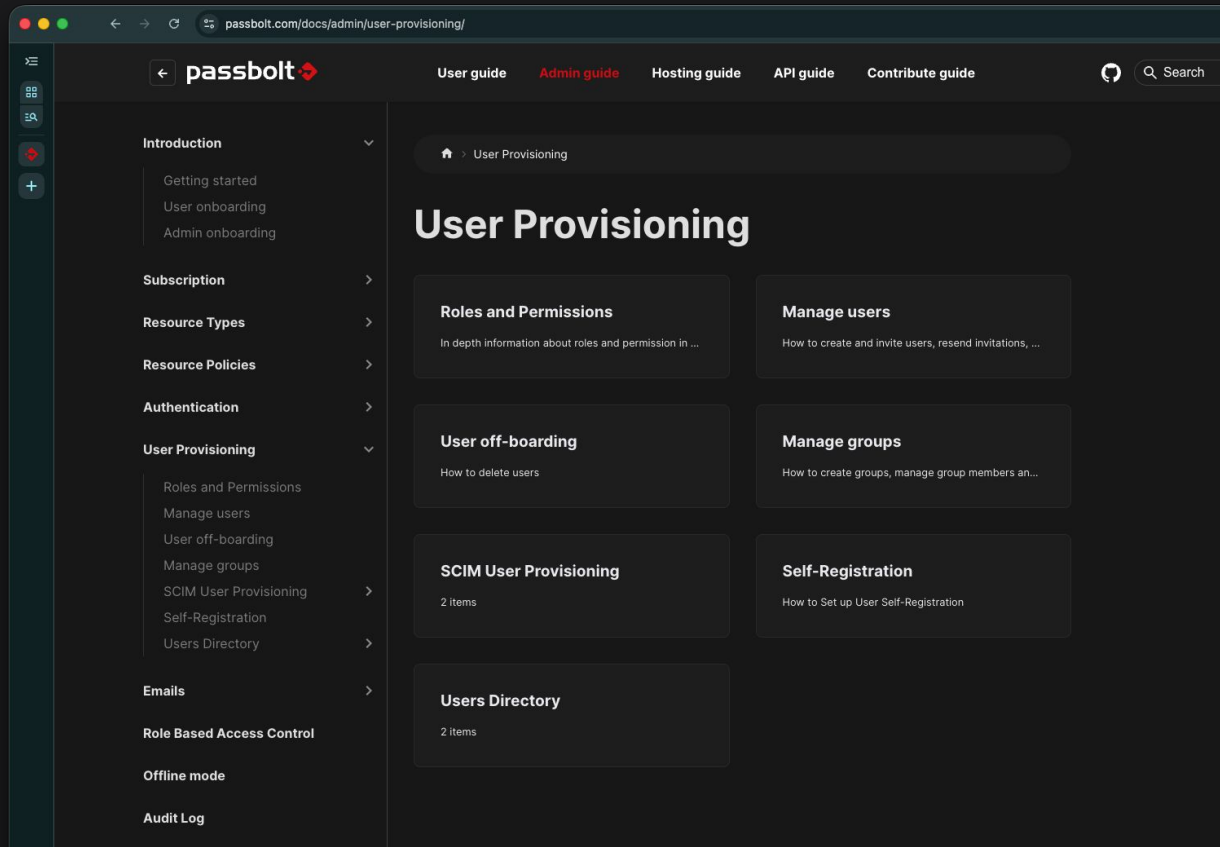
At the bottom right of the settings area is a 'Save' button.

Step 6. Bring your team onboard **User & Group Sync**

**Deploy progressively
(recommended)**

Import your users/groups

- ✓ LDAP sync (Pro)
- ✓ SCIM (Pro/Cloud)
- ✓ Self registration



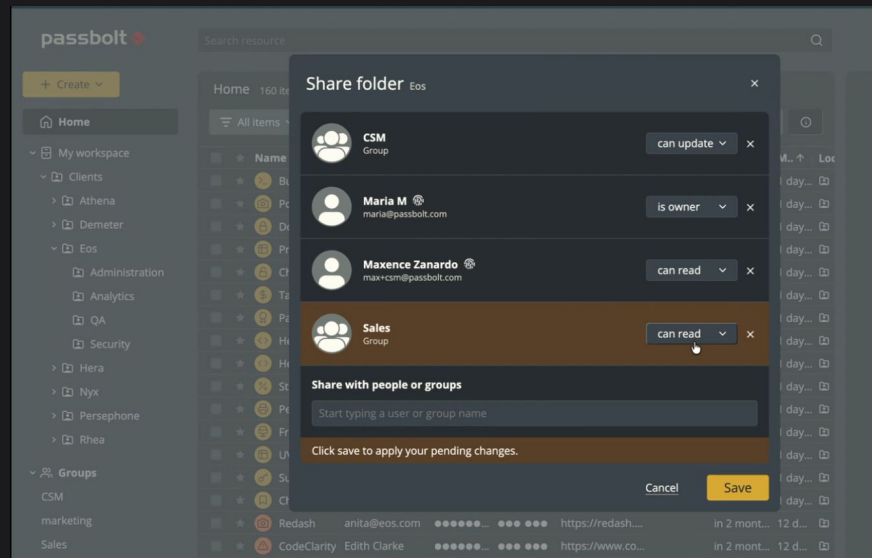
Step 7. Start secure collaboration **Folder Sharing & Permission**

Apply the "One-to-Many" Rule

- ✓ Link folders to groups.
- ✓ Manage permissions tier at the folder level. (The sub-folders and passwords will inherit the upper-permission rights unless you modify them).
- ✓ Avoid assigning access user by user.

Permission Tier	Capabilities	Can Share?
Can Read	View and use credentials only	No
Can Update	Create, Edit, and Delete items (folders, resources) in a folder	No
Is Owner	Full rights + Permission management	Yes

Passbolt requires every folder to have at least one owner at all times to prevent data from becoming orphaned.



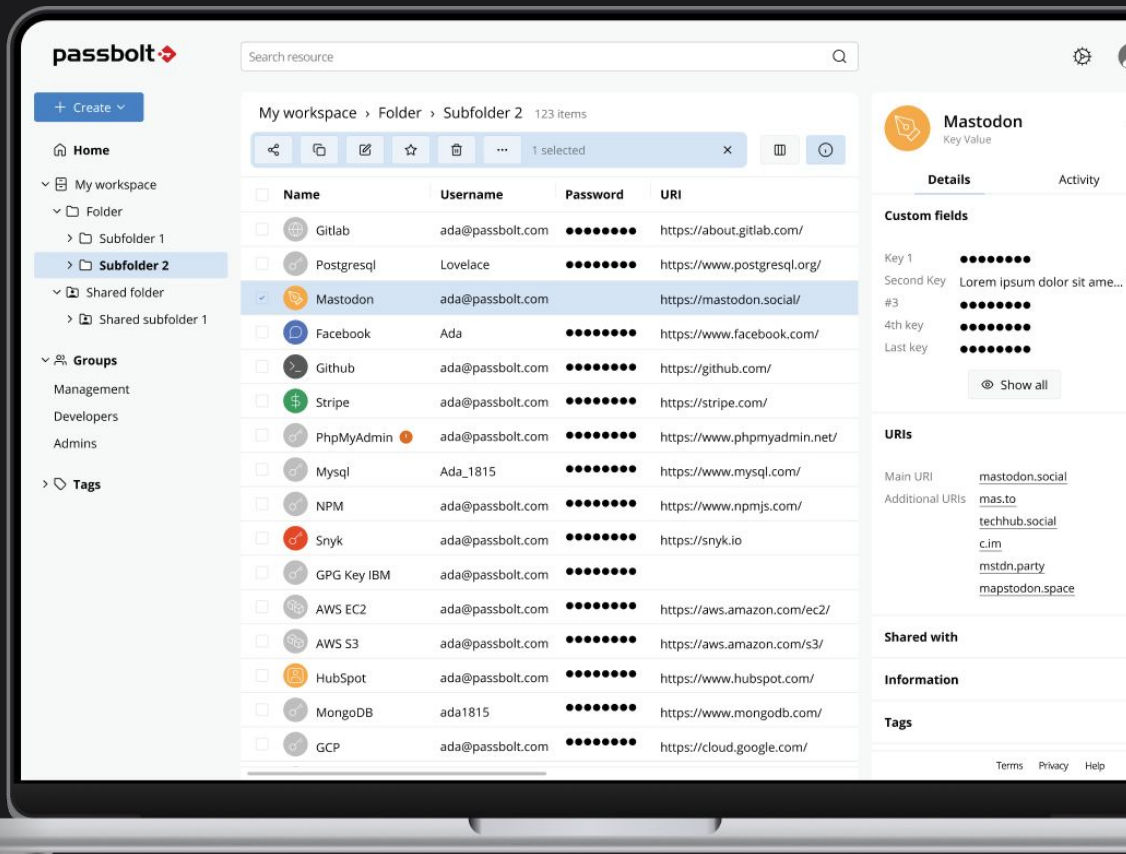
⚠ Avoid sharing passwords directly with individual users. Always go through groups. It makes (on/off)boarding and permission changes much easier

Beyond the setup

Two useful practices before rolling out

Onboarding Check

- ✓ **Verify user access** and sharing logic with test users.
- ✓ **Recovery Check.** Test the Organisation Recovery Key and Recovery process.



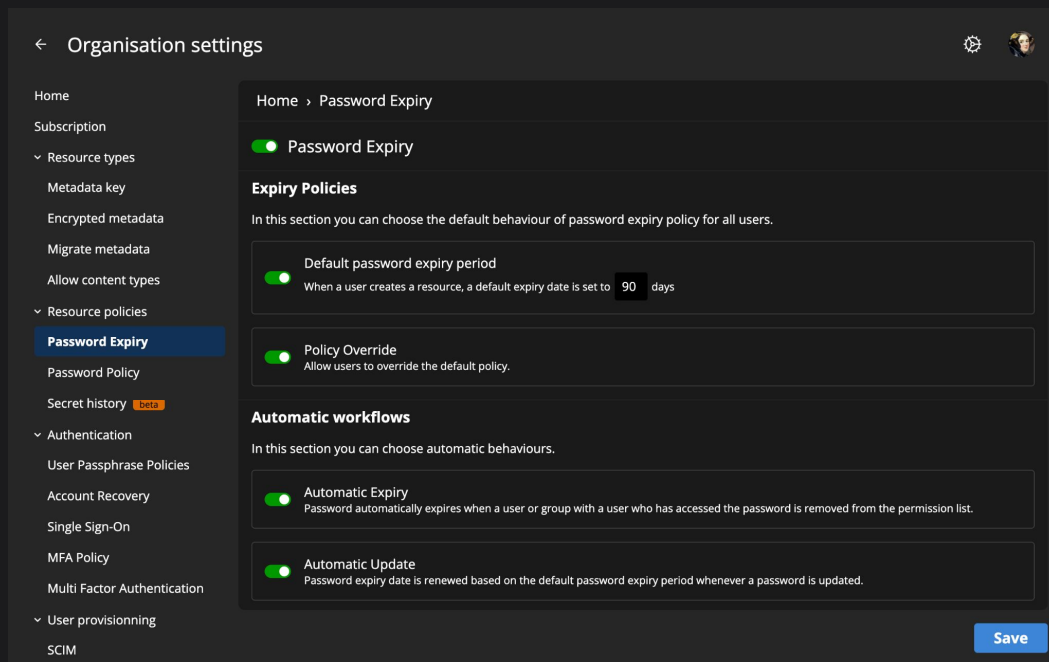
Offboarding Check and Credential Cleanup

Managing Password Expiry.

When a user is removed from a group, access is revoked immediately.

But credentials they previously accessed will be marked as (!) **expired** and should be rotated to maintain good security hygiene.

If a user is **sole owner** of elements (passwords, folders, groups), a pop-up will be displayed at the deletion of the user to **transfer** the ownership to another user.



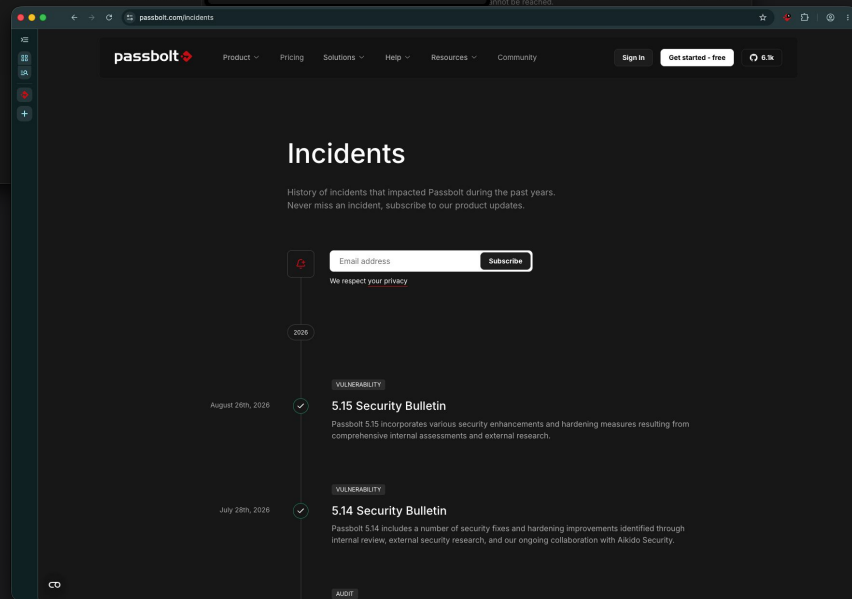
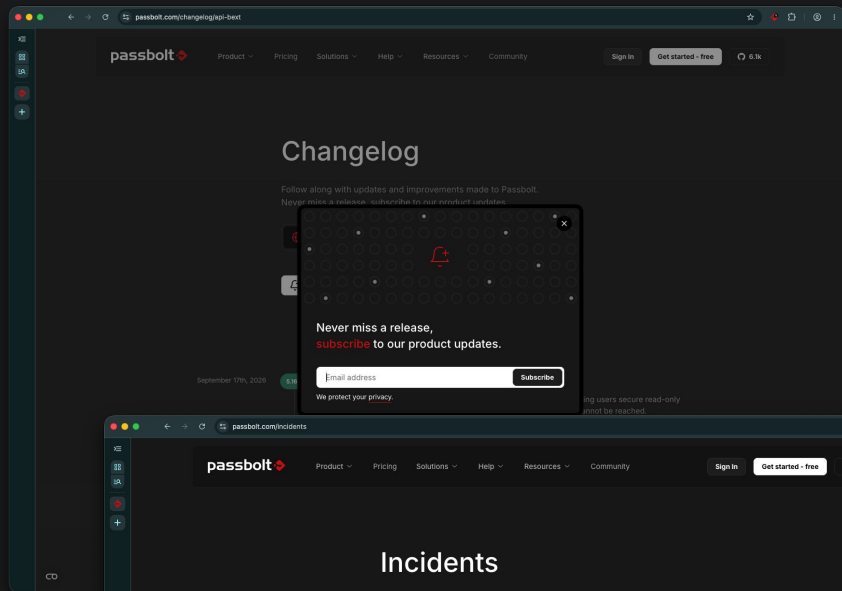
- ✓ **Flagged (!) credentials** were accessed, rotate these first
- ✓ Unflagged credentials were shared but never accessed, need no action

Useful resources

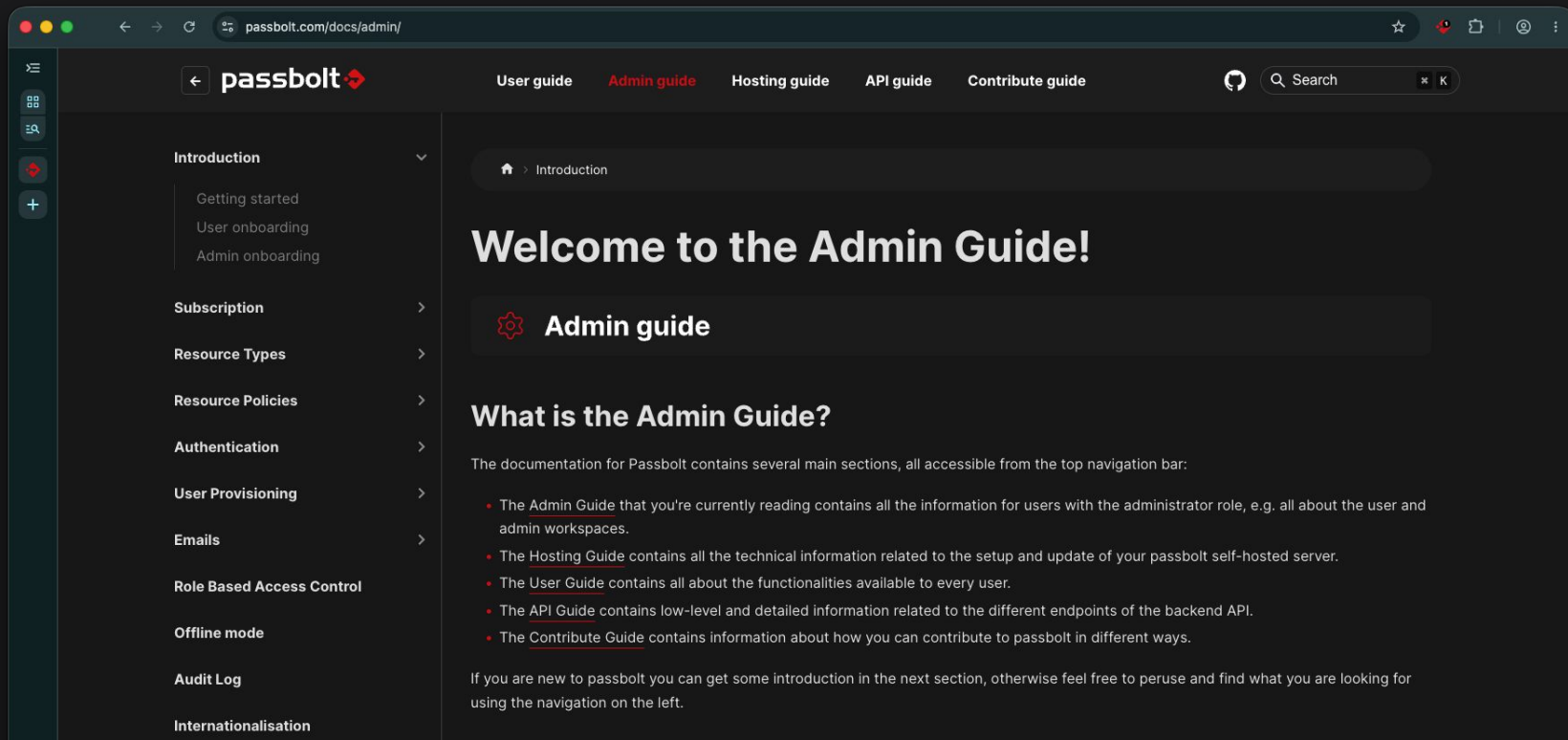
Where to learn more and get help

Subscribe to Updates and Alerts

- ✓ Subscribe to our monthly release updates to stay informed about new features.
- ✓ Subscribe to incidents to stay informed about any security incidents.

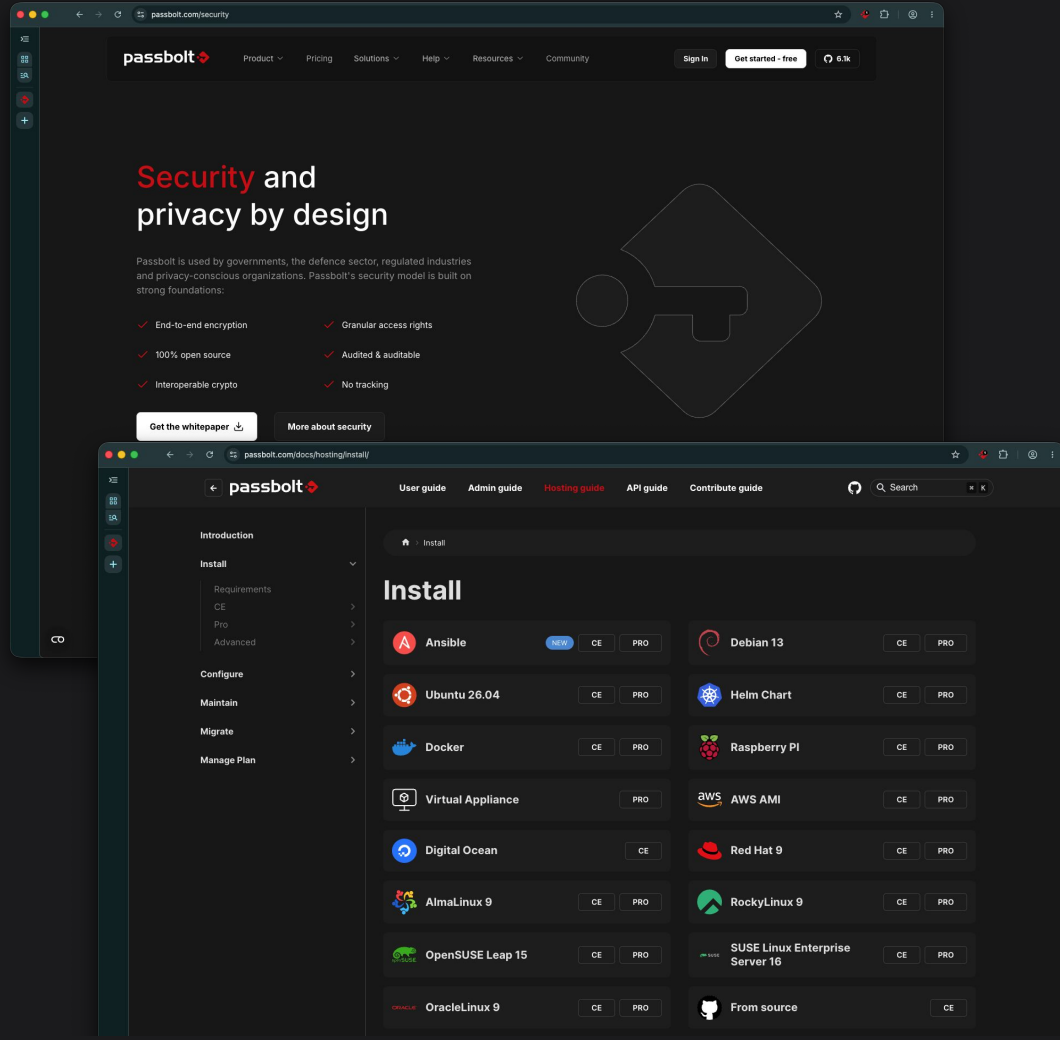


Browse the **admin guide**. Learn more about the other functionalities on the official documentation.

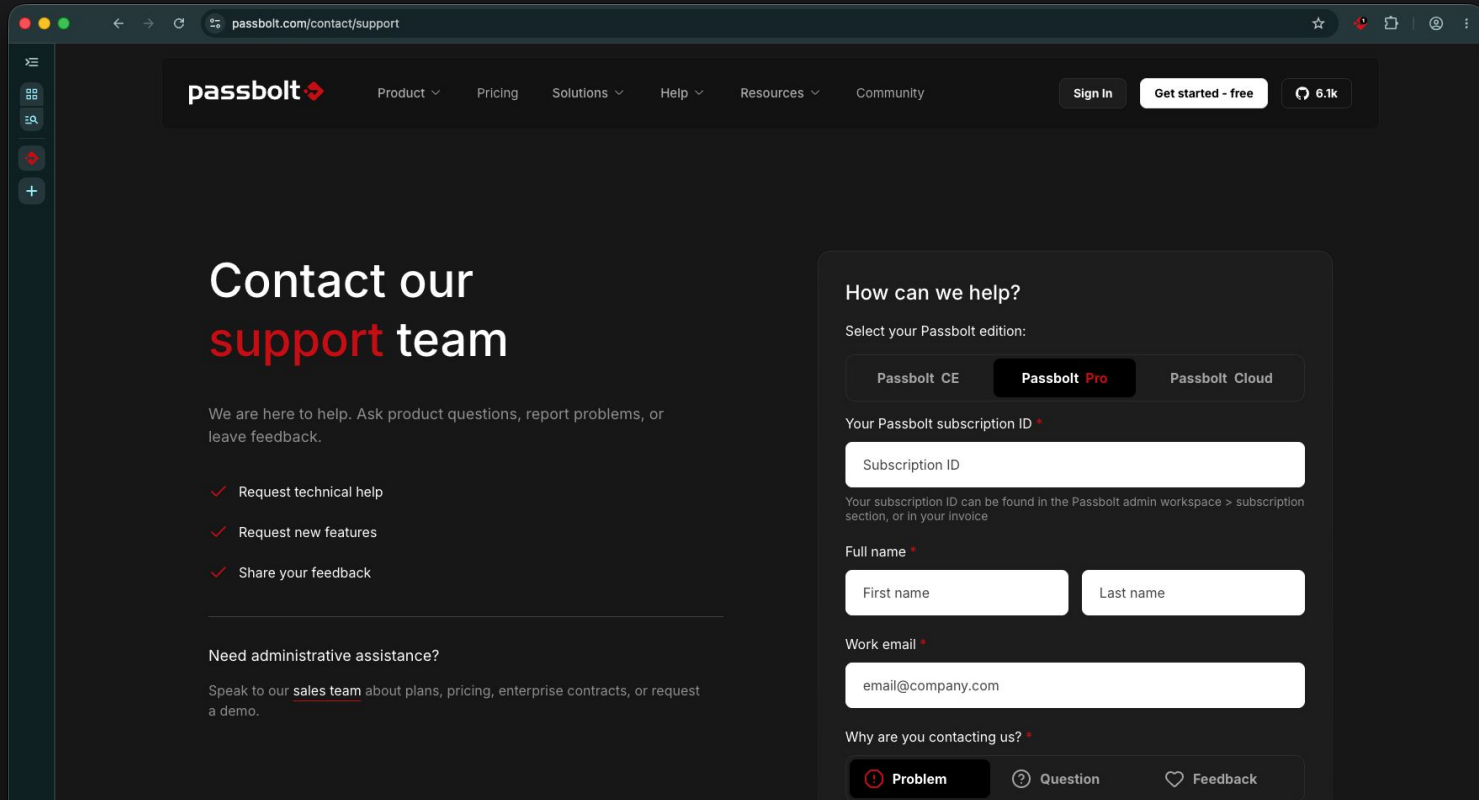


Passbolt Pro Edition Additional Resources

- ✓ Security White Paper Risk mitigation, residual risks, and security best practices checklist.
- ✓ Check the Hosting guide Installation, configuration, high availability, backup, and patching.



If you are stuck you can always look in the passbolt community forum or ask our tech support.

A screenshot of a web browser showing the Passbolt support page. The browser's address bar displays 'passbolt.com/contact/support'. The page has a dark theme. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the Passbolt logo, links for Product, Pricing, Solutions, Help, Resources, and Community, and buttons for Sign In, Get started - free, and a user icon with 6.1k followers. The main content area is titled 'Contact our support team' in large white and red text. Below the title, a paragraph states: 'We are here to help. Ask product questions, report problems, or leave feedback.' There are three bullet points with checkmarks: 'Request technical help', 'Request new features', and 'Share your feedback'. A horizontal line separates this section from the next one, which is titled 'Need administrative assistance?'. It says: 'Speak to our sales team about plans, pricing, enterprise contracts, or request a demo.' On the right side of the page, there is a form titled 'How can we help?'. It starts with 'Select your Passbolt edition:' and has three buttons: 'Passbolt CE', 'Passbolt Pro' (which is highlighted), and 'Passbolt Cloud'. Below this is 'Your Passbolt subscription ID *' with a text input field containing 'Subscription ID'. A small note says: 'Your subscription ID can be found in the Passbolt admin workspace > subscription section, or in your invoice'. Then there is 'Full name *' with two text input fields for 'First name' and 'Last name'. Next is 'Work email *' with a text input field containing 'email@company.com'. Finally, there is 'Why are you contacting us? *' with three buttons: 'Problem' (highlighted with a red icon), 'Question' (with a question mark icon), and 'Feedback' (with a heart icon).

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<https://mastodon.social/@passbolt>



<https://www.linkedin.com/company/passbolt/>



<https://www.youtube.com/user/passboltpassword>